

# Fall and winter flowers for containers

As summer annuals begin to fade, rejuvenate tired container displays with a range of fall- and winter-flowering plants.

The choice of fall and winter flowers is not huge, but the color range equals that of summer schemes, with hot-hued chrysanthemums, primrose, and dahlias, or cool-colored Chinese aster, dainty cyclamen, and spider lily. When buying bedding plants in early fall, check the labels for hardiness if the plant will soldier on after the first frost. Also remember that winter-flowering pansies do not actually bloom that well during very cold weather—small-headed violas are more reliable. The best displays can be achieved by sheltering pots on windowsills or close to house walls.



ANNUAL/BIBENNIAL MEDIUM

## *Callistephus chinensis*

**CHINA ASTER** This bushy annual bedding plant has oval, lobed green leaves and fall flowers in shades of pink, purple, white, and yellow that add color to containers of soil-based potting mix. Deadhead to prolong the flowering display.

†24in (60cm) ↔ 18in (45cm)

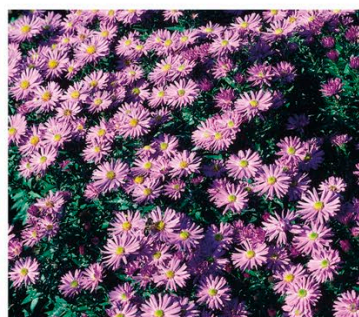


PERENNIAL SMALL

## *Ceratostigma plumbaginoides*

**PLUMBAGO** Plant this small bushy perennial in a windowbox or container filled with soil-based potting mix. Small blue late season flowers appear annually. Its green oval leaves take on spectacular red color in fall.

†18in (45cm) ↔ 8in (20cm)

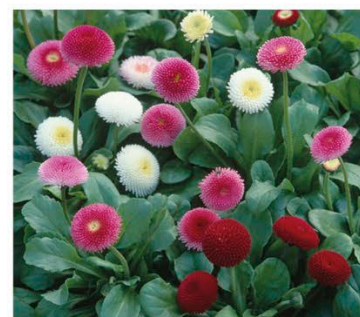


PERENNIAL SMALL

## *Aster novi-belgii* 'Professor Anton Kippenberg'

**Renamed *Symphyotrichum novi-belgii* 'Professor Anton Kippenburg'** This perennial's pastel-colored, daisy-like blooms are perfect for fall pots of soil-based potting mix. Water well to prevent powdery mildew.

†14in (35cm) ↔ 18in (45cm)

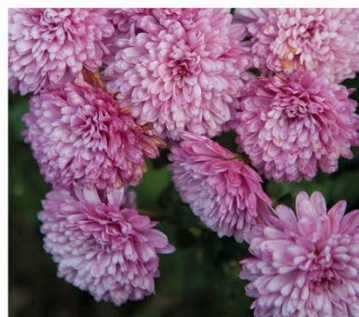


PERENNIAL SMALL

## *Bellis perennis*

**ENGLISH DAISY** This dwarf perennial, grown as an annual, bears pink, white, or red double or single blooms above green foliage starting from late winter in sheltered sites. Plant it in groups in potting soil with evergreen shrubs and violas.

†4in (10cm) ↔ 8in (20cm)



PERENNIAL SMALL

## *Chrysanthemum* hybrids

**GARDEN MUM** Plant this small-sized perennial in soil-based potting mix in a container or windowbox. Sprays of rounded, pink double blooms appear above lobed green foliage. Many variety in a large array of colors are available.

†18in (45cm) ↔ 16in (40cm)

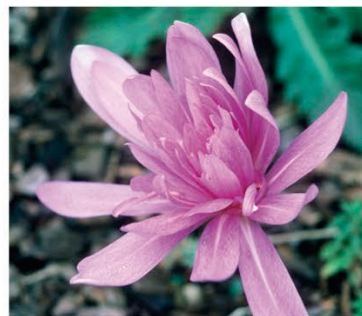


BULB MEDIUM

## *Colchicum byzantinum*

**AUTUMN CROCUS** Use this dainty perennial corm in small pots or windowboxes for a fall display of open funnel-shaped soft lilac flowers. The leaves appear later. Plant the corms in summer in soil-based potting mix.

†8in (20cm)

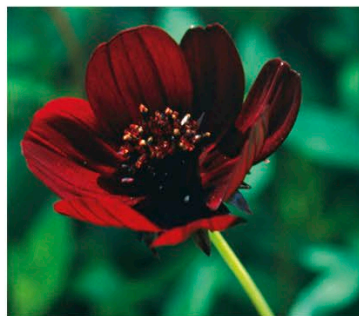


BULB MEDIUM

## *Colchicum* 'Waterlily'

**AUTUMN CROCUS** This perennial bulb, grown from corms, blooms in fall when pinkish lilac fully double flowers develop, followed by strap-shaped leaves soon after. Plant the corms in summer in small containers of soil-based potting mix.

†6in (15cm)

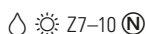


PERENNIAL MEDIUM

## *Cosmos atrosanguineus*

**CHOCOLATE COSMOS** This perennial's bowl-shaped, chocolate-scented dark maroon flowers are held on tall slim stems, from late summer to early fall above divided green leaves. Plant it in large containers of gritty soil-based potting mix.

†24in (60cm) or more ↔ 18in (45cm)

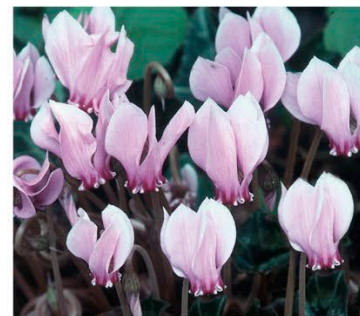


BULB SMALL

## *Cyclamen coum*

**HARDY CYCLAMEN** With its silver-marbled leaves and deep pink flowers, with twisted, swept-back petals, this dwarf perennial bulb offers late winter color. Plant in small containers or windowboxes in gritty soil-based potting mix. Goes dormant in summer.

†4in (10cm)



BULB SMALL

## *Cyclamen hederifolium*

**IVY-LEAVED CYCLAMEN** Add fall color to small containers filled with gritty soil-based potting mix with this dwarf perennial bulb. Its pink blooms bear swept-back petals and are followed by patterned silvery-green leaves. Goes dormant in summer.

†4in (10cm)

